

SQL Server Daily Health Check SOP

Production-focused operating procedure | Version 1.0

Purpose

Provide a consistent, read-only daily review of SQL Server health so DBAs can identify conditions that need investigation before they become larger availability, recoverability, or performance issues.

Scope

This SOP covers instance health, database state, backups, SQL Agent failures, database file space, transaction log health, blocking, long-running requests, and Always On Availability Group health. It does not authorize production changes or replace approved incident, change, backup, recovery, or DR procedures.

Safety rules

- Run the toolkit in read-only mode. Do not add remediation commands to the distributed health-check scripts.
- Confirm the target SQL Server instance and environment before execution.
- Do not kill sessions, shrink files, alter databases, restart services/jobs, or change configuration based only on one health-check result.
- Use organization-approved escalation and change procedures for remediation.
- Treat thresholds as configurable examples, not universal production policy.

Prerequisites

- Approved access to the target SQL Server instance.
- Sufficient metadata permissions for the selected checks; VIEW SERVER STATE is commonly required for server-level DMVs.
- Access to msdb metadata for backup and SQL Agent checks.
- Knowledge of expected database states, backup policy, RPO/RTO, and Availability Group topology.

Daily procedure

1. Confirm target

Verify server name, environment, maintenance window status, and whether any known incident/change is already in progress.

2. Run summary

Execute `10-Health-Check-Summary.sql`. Review PASS, INFO, WARNING, and CRITICAL results.

3. Investigate findings

For each non-PASS result, run the matching detailed script and gather context before deciding whether action is required.

4. Compare with policy

Validate backup age, log backup expectations, capacity, and AG state against your organization's approved standards.

5. Escalate appropriately

If a finding indicates material recoverability, availability, or production impact, follow the approved incident/escalation process.

6. Record outcome

Document meaningful findings and actions in the organization's ticketing, shift handoff, or operations record when required.

Check matrix

Check	Healthy / expected	Review condition	Primary action
Instance health	Normal uptime	Recent unexpected restart	Confirm restart/change history
Database status	ONLINE	Unexpected non-ONLINE state	Run database status detail; investigate state
Backup health	Within approved policy	Missing/stale full or log backup	Validate job, history, RPO/RTO, chain
SQL Agent	No unexpected failures	Failed job outcome	Review job/step history and impact
Database file space	Within planned capacity	Low free space inside file	Review growth, autogrowth, volume capacity
Transaction log	Normal utilization	High utilization / reuse wait	Review backups, transactions, reuse wait
Blocking	Normal/transient	Sustained blocking	Review blocking chain before intervention
Long-running requests	Expected workload	Unexpected duration	Review waits, plan, blocking, workload
Always On	Expected healthy state	Unexpected unhealthy state	Review mode, role, queues, connectivity

Severity guide

Severity	Meaning
PASS	No condition outside the configured threshold was detected.
INFO	Informational result that needs environment context.
WARNING	A condition needs DBA review; it may be expected or non-urgent.
CRITICAL	Potential material availability/recoverability risk that should be investigated promptly.

Escalation examples

- Unexpected database state affecting application availability.
- No usable backup coverage or a backup chain condition that threatens recovery objectives.
- Transaction log pressure that is actively affecting writes or storage availability.
- Sustained blocking with measurable production impact.

- Availability Group health degradation inconsistent with the designed topology or DR posture.

Close-out

A daily check is complete when all non-PASS findings have been reviewed, contextualized, and either documented as expected or routed through the appropriate approved operational process.

Disclaimer: Validate all scripts and procedures in non-production before use. This SOP is a generic operational template and must be adapted to your organization's requirements.